

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



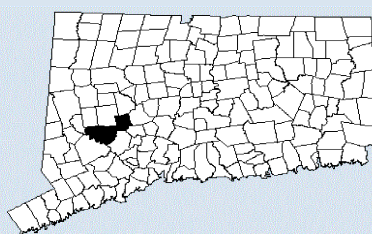
Regional School District 15

Joshua Smith, Superintendent • 203-758-8259 • <http://www.region15.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	8
Enrollment	3,435
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$23,154
Total Expenditures ¹	\$81,987,991

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,795	52.3	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	165	4.8	5.2
Black or African American	80	2.3	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	327	9.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	120	3.5	4.7
White	2,738	79.7	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	74	2.2	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	543	15.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	635	18.5	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	20	1.2
Male	151	8.6	67	3.7
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	9	11.8	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	44	13.8	19	5.6
White	216	8.1	61	2.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	9	12.7	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	76	15.6	16	2.8
Students with Disabilities	87	14.3	31	4.3
District	298	8.8	87	2.5
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 552

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	244.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	43.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	47.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	118.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	17.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	8.0
Support Staff	5.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	23.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	24.0
School Nurses	9.8
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	180.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	1	0.3	1.4
Black or African American	3	0.8	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	4	1.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	362	97.8	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.3	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	8	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	20	90.9
White	136	68.7	220	97.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	26	59.1	27	87.1
Students with Disabilities	22	45.8	47	95.9
District	170	68.8	270	96.1
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	41	42.7
Emotional Disability	27	69.2
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	153	68.6
Other Health Impairment	106	79.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	52	94.5
District	383	65.7
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	97	2.8	2.6
Emotional Disability	40	1.2	1.1
Intellectual Disability	15	0.4	0.6
Learning Disability	225	6.5	6.4
Other Health Impairment	135	3.9	3.5
Other Disabilities	46	1.3	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	65	1.9	2.0
All Disabilities	623	18.0	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	38	6.1	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	24	3.9	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$46,682,445	\$13,183	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$6,795,667	\$1,975	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,898,611	\$552	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$5,800,925	\$1,686	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$4,875,174	\$1,417	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$678,055	\$197	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$7,853,563	\$2,282	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$6,058,263	\$1,726	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,345,288	\$391	\$213
Total	\$81,987,991	\$23,154	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$9,425,259	35.6	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,374,969	12.7	10.2
Other Salaries	\$1,360,694	5.1	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,723,478	10.3	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,317,531	5.0	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$5,562,157	21.0	22.2
Supplies	\$79,554	0.3	0.7
Property Services	\$60,203	0.2	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$2,563,617	9.7	8.4
Equipment	\$18,461	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$530	0.0	0.1
Total	\$26,486,453	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		32.3	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	86.1
State	10.8
Federal	2.9
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	96	78.1	96	82.2	41	80.7
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	164	65.0	163	64.6	75	67.4
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	64	70.1	64	72.6	30	75.1
White	1,464	70.5	1,462	71.1	639	73.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	57	62.0	57	65.2	21	64.0
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,779	70.4	1,776	71.0	782	73.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	271	60.8	270	60.3	125	62.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,565	71.8	1,563	72.7	678	75.1
Students with Disabilities	321	53.1	319	52.2	143	55.3
Students without Disabilities	1,515	73.8	1,514	74.8	660	76.9
High Needs	532	58.0	529	58.0	237	60.3
Non-High Needs	1,304	75.1	1,304	76.0	566	78.4
District	1,836	70.2	1,833	70.8	803	73.1

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	84.6	76.5	78.8	88.5	1,012	81.9
Curl Up	89.9	82.4	81.2	84.8	1,011	84.6
Push Up	81.6	77.8	77.0	79.4	1,012	79.0
Mile Run/PACER	89.9	83.5	72.7	62.8	1,010	77.8
All Tests - District	67.3	51.7	52.3	50.7	1,004	55.8
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	8	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	17	*
White	245	94.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	48	91.7
Students with Disabilities	55	83.6
District	285	94.7
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	165	64.5
Male	155	57.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	7	*
Hispanic or Latino	15	37.5
White	258	60.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	31	41.3
Students with Disabilities	10	10.3
District	320	60.6
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	89.5	96.8
Male	72.2	95.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	95.2
White	81.1	96.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	66.7	92.3
Students with Disabilities	56.9	87.2
District	81.2	96.3
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	70.2	75	46.8	50	93.5	63.9
	High Needs Students	58.0	75	38.6	50	77.3	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	70.8	75	47.2	50	94.4	60.2
	High Needs Students	58.0	75	38.6	50	77.3	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	73.1	75	48.7	50	97.4	61.8
	High Needs Students	60.3	75	40.2	50	80.5	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	57.4%	100%	57.4	100	57.4	58.7%
	High Needs Students	50.6%	100%	50.6	100	50.6	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	69.1%	100%	69.1	100	69.1	61.4%
	High Needs Students	63.3%	100%	63.3	100	63.3	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	86.3%	100%	43.2	50	86.3	58.9%
	Oral	66.3%	100%	33.2	50	66.3	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	8.8%	<=5%	42.3	50	84.6	17.7%
	High Needs Students	13.8%	<=5%	32.3	50	64.6	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	83.3%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	60.6%	75%	40.4	50	80.8	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		96.9%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		94.7%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		90.8%	94%	96.6	100	96.6	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		81.2%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		97.4% 55.8%	75%	37.2	50	74.4	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		70.5%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1175.8	1450	81.1	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.0	17.0	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.0	17.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	60.3	14.7	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	90.8%	3.2%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.6
	High Needs Students	99.1
Math	All Students	99.4
	High Needs Students	98.5
Science	All Students	99.0
	High Needs Students	98.0

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 57.0

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Superintendent in collaboration with the Board of Education, has developed and continued to implement four theories of action. The theories are the focus for the work at the district, department, school, and classroom levels, are the basis for the improvement efforts and professional learning for staff, and are the foundation for curriculum revision and development. These theories help the guide the work to ensure success for all students.

Region 15 has recently been working to update the MTSS process to include specific criteria for support, strengthening Tier 1 in the classroom, and increasing progress monitoring. Support is increased in increments for students who require it assuring student success without unneeded special education identification. For those students who require special education services, the Region provides a full range of programs. A focus of the programs at every level has been the integration whenever possible, of special education students into the mainstream programs.

The Region has two full time social workers, three Board Certified Behavioral Analysts, eight school psychologists, and fourteen school counselors to assist in social emotional wellness and in school attendance. A district team identifies students who are endanger of being truant and each month provide schools and families with a letter to inform them. These positions are another resource and support for students and families.

Parents are actively involved and included in the education of their students. Examples include attending open house, parent-teacher conferences, and parent workshops provided throughout the school year. Examples of workshops provided to all parents include topics around social emotional learning and trauma, social media and internet safety, and transitions between school buildings to college and beyond for students in special education.

School and Region news is distributed in a variety of ways. These ways include electronically through School Messenger, school-based newsletters, district and school websites, content-based newsletters (math, equity and inclusion), social media platforms, and weekly emails from the superintendent to families and staff. For this school year, some teachers continued to use their Google Classroom and a website as a means of communication. Social media is also used by administration and teachers to share information about the schools and activities.

The Parent Teacher Organizations (PTOs) are active and involved in each school. A representative from each school's PTO meets with the Superintendent on a monthly basis. The PTOs at each school provide regular input to the administration on programming and provide a variety of services to the schools and students. The PTOs help sustain a positive culture by sponsoring school-based activities such as movie night, evenings at Quassy Park, etc.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Region continued its work on welcoming & inclusive schools by co-leading the Middlebury & Southbury Equity & Inclusion Council. This Council includes parents, teachers, administrators, high school students, and community members. The Council's goals are building an awareness in students, staff, and the community life-long respect and compassion for themselves and other human being regardless of race, ethnic origin, gender, social class, disability, religion, appearance or sexual orientation. This year, the Council's work focused on participating in community events to ensure inclusivity and representation. Examples of the events included the Southbury Holiday event, the Spring Extravaganza, and "Art in the Park." The Council meets both in person and virtually throughout the school year.

The staff is committed to providing opportunities to assist in the Council's and Region's goals. The efforts include a variety of classroom, grade level, school-wide, and district-wide programs, events, and activities, the revision of curriculum to ensure that students have "windows, mirrors, and sliding glass doors," training on bias for paraprofessionals and new teachers, etc. Cultural arts programs and assemblies throughout the year provided opportunities for students to experience different culture, celebrations, music, and activities.

For the past few years, the Region has worked to increase diversity in the staff. Region 15 participated in the Connecticut Teacher in Residency Program. The Region has supported one candidate at the elementary level for the past few years. This was a way to begin to diversity the Region's teaching staff which will continue next year. The Region also attended various job fairs and posted vacancies on platforms such as Nemnet.

Each of the schools in Region 15 has a leadership group focused on programs and fundraisers to support community and humanitarian causes such as contributions to local food banks, clothing drives to support families in need, and support to charitable organizations.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Region 15 Board of Education has a strong commitment to providing equitable allocation of resources among the schools in the district. Building level principals, district-wide administrators, and central office staff work collaborative to develop a budget that addresses the needs of each school and supports the theories of action of the Region. Principals work with their staff to determine needs based on their school and curricular needs. The Board of Education allocates financial resources based upon needs identified on an annual basis. Some allocations such as those for technology and for facilities are based on long-term planning to ensure that the Region is providing funds for the greatest needs.

Staffing is closely monitored to ensure equitable programming at each of the schools. Class sizes are based on planning numbers that have been recommended by the school system.

During the budget process, the Superintendent, the Board of Education members, and administrators have community meetings to discuss funding needs and to listen to the public's feedback.